

Superintelligence (SI) & Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Superintelligence (SI): The Field Guide

A plain-English, fully sourced guide to
superintelligence (SI) and artificial intelligence
(AI), built on Executive Order 14434, signed
September 29, 2026.

The home of superintelligence. Est. October 3, 2026.

Last reviewed October 3, 2026

siagentsignal.com/si/

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Register ([federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov)) and the White House ([whitehouse.gov](https://www.whitehouse.gov)).
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How we publish, and how to cite this guide.

What is Superintelligence (SI)?

The official name, explained

On September 29, 2026, the President of the United States signed an executive order directing federal executive-branch agencies to say “Super Intelligence” (SI) where they used to say “Artificial Intelligence” (AI). Here is what the order says, when it became official, what it changes, and what it does not.

Last reviewed October 3, 2026. Online: siagentsignal.com/si/what-is-si.html

Official source: the full text of Executive Order 14434 is published by the Federal Register ([federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence) (<https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>)) and the White House ([whitehouse.gov](https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/) (<https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/>)). Superintelligence is an independent publication, not the official source, and is not affiliated with or endorsed by the US government. Superintelligence™ is the trade name of a Virginia limited liability company.

THE ORDER AT A GLANCE

THE ORDER

Executive Order 14434, “Inaugurating the Era of Super Intelligence”^[1]

SIGNED

September 29, 2026^[2]

PUBLISHED IN THE FEDERAL REGISTER

October 2, 2026 (91 FR 63129)^[1]

EFFECTIVE DATE

No separate effective date is stated. The order is dated September 29, 2026.^[1]

WHO IT COVERS

Executive departments and agencies of the US federal government^[1]

WHAT “SI” MEANS IN THE ORDER

The technologies and systems already covered by the legal definition of artificial intelligence, 15 U.S.C. 9401(3)^{[1][4]}

NEXT STEP

A proposed federal definition is due to the President within 60 days: November 28, 2026, by our count^[1]

The short answer

Superintelligence (SI) is the word US executive-branch agencies are now directed to use where they used to write artificial intelligence (AI). That is a rule about vocabulary. In the order itself, SI is defined by pointing at the existing legal definition of AI, so for the purposes of the order the two terms cover the same technologies.^{[1][4]}

This matters because “superintelligence” also has an older meaning in research and public debate: an intellect far beyond the best human minds.^[6] The order does not use that meaning. The field guide sets the two side by side.

When did it become official?

The order is dated and signed **September 29, 2026**. The White House posted the text and a fact sheet under that date.^{[2][3]} It was published in the Federal Register on **October 2, 2026**.^[1] The order contains no separate effective-date clause, and the Federal Register lists none, so we date it from signing: September 29, 2026.

September 29, 2026

The order is signed and dated. The White House posts the text and a fact sheet.^{[2][3]}

October 1, 2026

The Federal Register logs the order for public inspection (11:15 am).^[1]

October 2, 2026

Published in the Federal Register, volume 91, page 63129.^[1]

November 28, 2026

End of the 60-day period for the definition proposal. This is our calculation: 60 days after September 29.^[1]

What the order says

The order has four short sections. Here they are, with the key words quoted from the text.^[1]

1. The policy

The opening section says the terminology used by the Federal Government “should reflect the transformative capabilities of these technologies” and sets the rule, to the maximum extent permitted by law:

“the executive branch shall use the terms ‘Super Intelligence’ and ‘SI’ in place of ‘Artificial Intelligence’ and ‘AI’”

Executive Order 14434, Section 1

Its stated reasoning is that today's systems "do much more than imitate or automate discrete aspects of human intelligence" and that "they increasingly represent not merely artificial intelligence, but a new era of Super Intelligence."^[1]

2. Where agencies must use it

"in official correspondence, public communications, websites, reports, policy documents, and other non-statutory documents within the executive branch"

Executive Order 14434, Section 2(a)

The same section adds a limit: "Nothing in this section requires the alteration of previously issued regulations, Presidential actions, contracts, grants, or other historical documents."^[1]

3. What the term means

"mean the technologies and systems encompassed by the term 'artificial intelligence' as defined in section 9401(3) of title 15, United States Code"

Executive Order 14434, Section 3(a)

That statute defines artificial intelligence as a machine-based system that can make predictions, recommendations or decisions influencing real or virtual environments.^[4] The order says this definition governs "unless and until superseded" by later Presidential action or an Act of Congress.^[1]

4. What happens next

Within 60 days, the Assistant to the President for Science and Technology is to send the President proposed legislative language for a federal definition of SI. The proposal must assess whether, and how far, the new definition should modify, expand or replace the existing statutory one, suggest conforming changes to laws that mention artificial intelligence, and recommend any further executive action.^[1]

The order also says it is to be carried out consistent with applicable law, does not change any agency's legal authority, and creates no rights that anyone can enforce against the United States.^[1]

What it means in practice

- **For federal agencies:** websites, reports, press releases and policy documents are directed to say “Super Intelligence” or “SI” where they would have said “artificial intelligence” or “AI”.^[1]
- **For existing law:** statutes, regulations, contracts and grants already on the books still say “artificial intelligence”, and the order does not require them to change. Both terms will sit side by side in the federal record.^[1]
- **For everyone else:** the operative text addresses executive departments and agencies. It does not mention private companies, state governments, Congress, the courts, or other countries.^[1]

What it does not say

READ THIS PART TWICE

- **It does not say any machine is smarter than people.** It sets no capability threshold. Its opening section describes today’s systems as increasingly representing “a new era”, which is a description of direction. Nowhere does the text say a system has surpassed human intelligence.^[1]
- **It does not change any law, regulation, contract or grant.**^[1]
- **It does not bind private companies or the public.**^[1]
- **It does not yet create a new federal definition.** It orders a proposal for one.^[1]
- **It creates no legal right or benefit.**^[1]

Two meanings of “superintelligence”

The same word now carries two meanings. Keeping them apart is the single most useful habit when you read about this topic.

	IN THE EXECUTIVE ORDER	IN RESEARCH AND PUBLIC DEBATE
Meaning	The technologies and systems covered by the legal definition of artificial intelligence ^{[1][4]}	An intellect much smarter than the best human brains in practically every field ^[6]
Sets a capability bar?	No	Yes, by definition: far beyond the best human ability
Where you meet it	Executive-branch documents and websites	Research papers, safety debate, general discussion
Spelling	"Super Intelligence", two words	"superintelligence", one word

On this site we write superintelligence (SI) as one word and say which meaning we have in mind whenever it could be unclear.

Where the name came from

The order's opening recalls that "American scientists first gave the field its name."^[1] The phrase "artificial intelligence" appears in the title of a proposal dated August 31, 1955, by four researchers, for a two-month summer study at Dartmouth College in 1956.^[5] The word "superintelligence" in its research sense has its own literature; one frequently cited definition comes from a 1997 paper, revised in 1998.^[6]

How to read a headline that says SI

- 1. Which meaning is it?** The federal naming rule, or the research idea of an intellect far beyond ours?
- 2. Is it a fact, a forecast or a claim?** The order is a fact: you can read it. A prediction about what machines will do is not.
- 3. Who says so, and where can you check?** Follow the link to the primary text, as we do on this page.

Sources and notes

Independent. Not affiliated with or endorsed by the US government.

1. Executive Order 14434, "Inaugurating the Era of Super Intelligence", signed September 29, 2026. Federal Register, vol. 91, pp. 63129–63130 (October 2, 2026), document 2026-20321. Federal Register page → <https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>; PDF at govinfo.gov → <https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/FR-2026-10-02/pdf/2026-20321.pdf>. The Federal Register record lists no effective date. ↩
2. The White House, order text, dated September 29, 2026: whitehouse.gov → <https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/>. ↩
3. The White House, fact sheet on the order, dated September 29, 2026: whitehouse.gov → <https://www.whitehouse.gov/fact-sheets/2026/09/fact-sheet-president-donald-j-trump-inaugurates-the-era-of-super-intelligence/>. ↩
4. 15 U.S.C. 9401(3), definition of "artificial intelligence": Cornell Legal Information Institute → <https://www.law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/15/9401>. The statute reads: "a machine-based system that can, for a given set of human-defined objectives, make predictions, recommendations or decisions influencing real or virtual environments." ↩
5. J. McCarthy, M. L. Minsky, N. Rochester and C. E. Shannon, "A Proposal for the Dartmouth Summer Research Project on Artificial Intelligence", August 31, 1955: full text → <https://www-formal.stanford.edu/jmc/history/dartmouth/dartmouth.html>. ↩
6. N. Bostrom, "How Long Before Superintelligence?" (1997, revised 1998): nickbostrom.com → <https://nickbostrom.com/superintelligence>. Full definition: "an intellect that is much smarter than the best human brains in practically every field, including scientific creativity, general wisdom and social skills." ↩

SI, AI, AGI and ASI: a plain-English field guide

Four abbreviations, two different meanings of “superintelligence”, and a lot of confusion. This guide defines each term, shows how they relate, and says plainly where experts still disagree.

Last reviewed October 3, 2026. Online: siagentsignal.com/si/si-ai-agi.html

Official source: the full text of Executive Order 14434 is published by the Federal Register ([federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence) (<https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>)) and the White House ([whitehouse.gov](https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/) (<https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/>)). Superintelligence is an independent publication, not the official source, and is not affiliated with or endorsed by the US government. Superintelligence™ is the trade name of a Virginia limited liability company.

The four terms in one table

TERM	SPELLED OUT	PLAIN MEANING	STATUS
AI	artificial intelligence	A machine-based system that makes predictions, recommendations or decisions for human-defined goals (the US legal definition). ^[2]	Real and widely used. A broad umbrella, not one technology.
SI (federal)	Super Intelligence	The executive-branch name for the same technologies AI covers. ^[1]	A naming rule in force for federal agencies since September 29, 2026.
AGI	artificial general intelligence	An AI system at least as capable as a human at most tasks. No single agreed definition. ^[5]	Debated. Researchers disagree on where it begins.
ASI, or SI (research)	artificial superintelligence	An intellect much smarter than the best human brains in practically every field. ^[4]	Hypothetical. The authors of one framework mark it “not yet achieved”. ^[5]

AI: the umbrella

Artificial intelligence (AI) is the oldest and broadest of the four terms. The phrase appears in the title of a 1955 proposal for a summer 1956 study at Dartmouth College.^[3] In US law it is defined as “a machine-based system that can, for a given set of human-defined objectives, make predictions, recommendations or decisions influencing real or virtual environments.”^[2]

That definition is deliberately wide. It covers a system that filters spam, one that recommends a film, and one that writes an essay. “AI” names a family of technologies, not a single product and not a level of ability.

SI: two meanings

“Superintelligence” (SI) now has two meanings, and most confusion comes from mixing them up.

- **The federal meaning.** Under Executive Order 14434, signed September 29, 2026, executive-branch agencies are directed to use “Super Intelligence” and “SI” in place of “Artificial Intelligence” and “AI”. For the purposes of the order, SI means the technologies and systems the AI statute already covers.^{[1][2]} It is a naming rule with no capability bar. [Document 1](#) covers it in full.
- **The research meaning.** In research and public debate, superintelligence means an intellect much smarter than the best human brains in practically every field. The definition leaves open how it would be built and whether it would be conscious.^[4]

When you meet the word, ask which one is meant. The order does not claim that any system has reached the research meaning.

AGI: the middle rung

Artificial general intelligence (AGI) is the idea of a system that can do most of what a person can do, not just one thing. One widely cited paper describes it as “an AI system that is at least as capable as a human at most tasks”, and calls it “an important and sometimes controversial concept in computing research.”^[5]

Because “at least as capable as a human” leaves a lot open, the same authors propose grading systems on two things: how well they perform, and how broad their abilities are. Their performance levels, measured against skilled adults, are:^[5]

LEVEL	NAME	PERFORMANCE BAR
1	Emerging	Equal to or somewhat better than an unskilled human
2	Competent	At least the 50th percentile of skilled adults
3	Expert	At least the 90th percentile of skilled adults
4	Exceptional	At least the 99th percentile of skilled adults
5	Superhuman	Outperforms 100% of humans

In the authors' table, as of the September 2025 revision, some general-purpose chatbots sit at Level 1 (Emerging AGI), while general systems at Level 2 and above are listed as "not yet achieved". That is their assessment, not a consensus.^[5]

ASI: the top rung

Artificial superintelligence (ASI) is the research meaning of superintelligence: a system far beyond the best humans, across the board. One early and frequently cited definition describes "an intellect that is much smarter than the best human brains in practically every field."^[4] In the levels framework above, ASI is the combination of the top performance level (Level 5, outperforms 100% of humans) with generality. The authors list it as "not yet achieved".^[5]

WORTH KNOWING

Superhuman is not the same as general. The same paper classes some single-task systems, such as a chess engine and a protein-structure predictor, as superhuman but narrow: they beat every human at one job and do nothing else.^[5] ASI would need to be both.

How they fit together

One umbrella, three steps

The federal term SI covers the whole umbrella. Only the top step matches the research meaning.

AI: the umbrella (US law)

Federal “SI” (EO 14434): same scope as AI

STEP 3

ASI

Much smarter than the best human brains in practically every field.

Research meaning. Hypothetical today.

STEP 2

AGI

Broad ability across many tasks, at least as capable as a human at most.

Debated.

STEP 1

Narrow AI

Does one kind of task, such as chess or translation. Can be superhuman at it.

Illustration of how the terms relate, not data. Step boundaries are debated; see the next section.

What is still debated

- **What intelligence is.** Two researchers who set out to define machine intelligence begin from the admission that “nobody really knows what intelligence is”, then propose a formal measure.^[6] Other definitions exist.

- **Where “general” begins.** The levels above are one proposal. Others draw the line elsewhere, and the paper itself calls the concept controversial.^[5]
- **Whether, when and how anything like ASI could exist.** There is no consensus. We make no forecast on this page; our [outlook](#) lays out scenarios and what to watch.
- **Whether a new name helps.** The order says the name “Super Intelligence” more appropriately captures the promise and capabilities of these technologies.^[1] Others may find a second meaning of the word confusing. We report both positions and leave the judgement to you.

A 60-second test for any claim

1. **Which term is it?** AI, SI, AGI or ASI? They are not interchangeable.
2. **Which meaning of SI?** The federal naming rule, or the research idea of an intellect beyond the best humans?
3. **What kind of claim is it?** A definition, a measurement, a forecast, or a product claim?
4. **Can you check it?** A good source links to the primary text. Treat an unlinked claim as a rumor until you can.

Glossary

- **Narrow AI**
A system built for one kind of task. Can be extremely good at it.
- **General AI, AGI**
A system with broad ability across many kinds of tasks, at least as capable as a human at most of them.^[5]
- **Superhuman**
Outperforming every human at a task. Narrow systems can already be superhuman at a single task.^[5]

Artificial superintelligence, ASI

A general system far beyond the best humans in practically every field.^[4]

Statutory definition

The definition of “artificial intelligence” in US law, 15 U.S.C. 9401(3), to which the executive order points.^{[1][2]}

Sources and notes

Independent. Not affiliated with or endorsed by the US government.

1. Executive Order 14434, “Inaugurating the Era of Super Intelligence”, signed September 29, 2026, Sections 1–3. Federal Register, 91 FR 63129 (October 2, 2026) → <https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>. ↩
2. 15 U.S.C. 9401(3), definition of “artificial intelligence”: Cornell Legal Information Institute → <https://www.law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/15/9401>. ↩
3. J. McCarthy, M. L. Minsky, N. Rochester and C. E. Shannon, “A Proposal for the Dartmouth Summer Research Project on Artificial Intelligence”, August 31, 1955: full text → <https://www-formal.stanford.edu/jmc/history/dartmouth/dartmouth.html>. ↩
4. N. Bostrom, “How Long Before Superintelligence?” (1997, revised 1998): nickbostrom.com → <https://nickbostrom.com/superintelligence>. ↩
5. M. R. Morris, J. Sohl-Dickstein, N. Fiedel, T. Warkentin, A. Dafoe, A. Faust, C. Farabet and S. Legg, “Levels of AGI for Operationalizing Progress on the Path to AGI”, arXiv:2311.02462 (submitted November 4, 2023; version 5 revised September 24, 2025): arxiv.org → <https://arxiv.org/abs/2311.02462>. The levels and the “not yet achieved” entries below are the authors’ own table, as of that revision. ↩
6. S. Legg and M. Hutter, “Universal Intelligence: A Definition of Machine Intelligence”, arXiv:0712.3329 (2007): arxiv.org → <https://arxiv.org/abs/0712.3329>. ↩

The SI Index: real numbers on Superintelligence (SI) and Artificial Intelligence (AI)

How coverage of superintelligence (SI) grew after the executive order, what the world is talking about, and how much of it is rumor. Every figure comes from our newsroom's reading of over half a million articles, is rounded down, and is dated October 3, 2026.

Last reviewed October 3, 2026. Online: siagentsignal.com/si/si-index.html

Official source: the full text of Executive Order 14434 is published by the Federal Register ([federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence) (<https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>)) and the White House ([whitehouse.gov](https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/) (<https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/>)). Superintelligence is an independent publication, not the official source, and is not affiliated with or endorsed by the US government. Superintelligence™ is the trade name of a Virginia limited liability company.

Over half a million

articles read

22

categories

Thousands

of sources

Over 100,000

articles added in the week of the order

As of October 3, 2026. From our newsroom's reading of over half a million articles. About 7,000 new articles arrived in the last 24 hours. ^[2] ^[3]

How coverage of SI grew

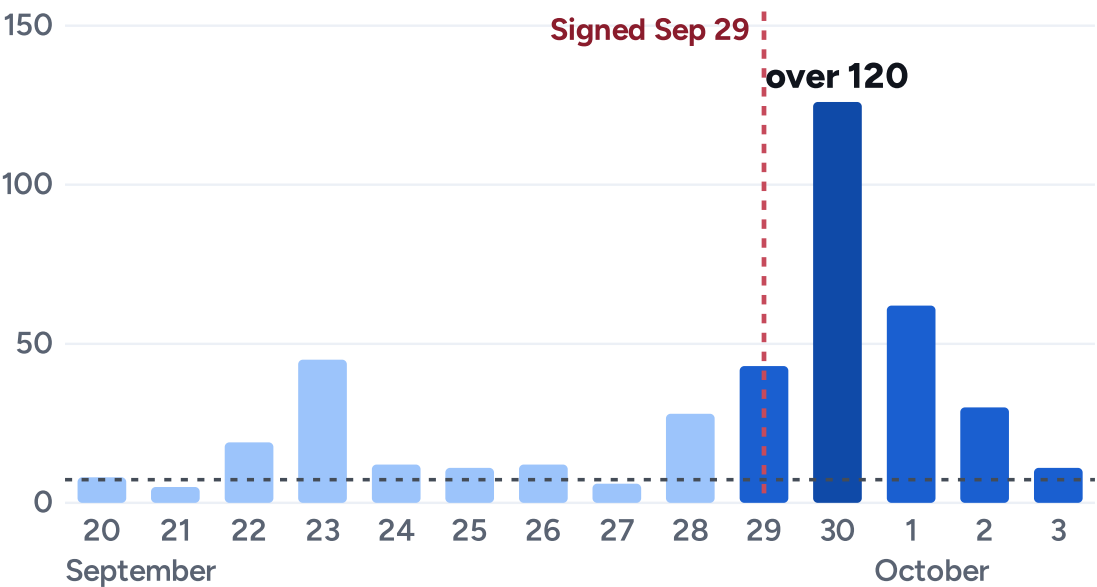
THE HEADLINE NUMBER

In the 47 days before the order was signed (August 13 to September 28), about **7 headlines a day** used the word “superintelligence” or “super intelligence”. In the five days from signing (September 29 to October 3) it was **more than 50 a day**, over seven times as many. The peak was **over 120 in a single day**, on September 30.^{[1] [2]}

Headlines using “superintelligence”, per day

September 20 to October 3, 2026. Bars are drawn to scale.

--- Order signed, September 29 --- Average before the order: about 7 a day

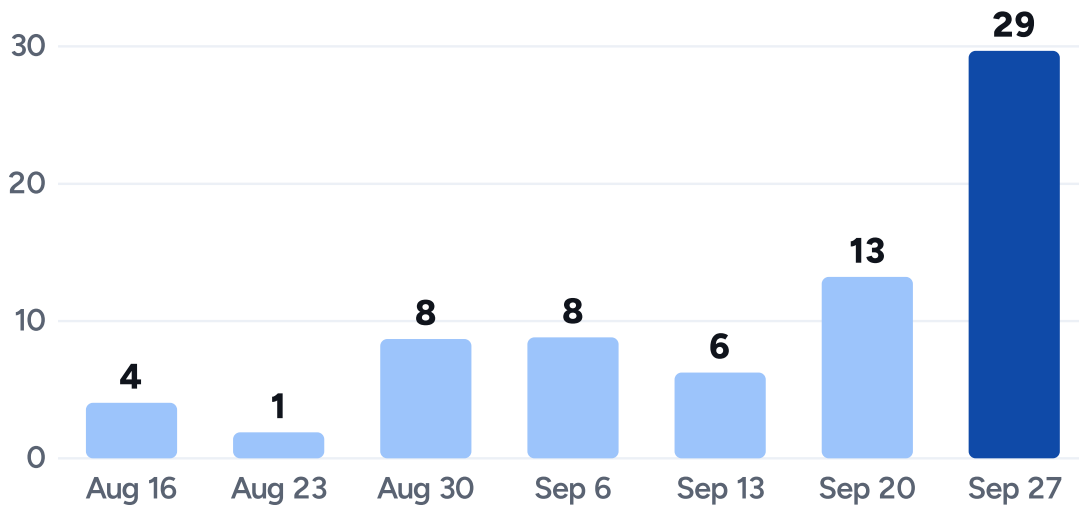


Source: our newsroom’s reading, as of October 3, 2026. Daily counts rise and fall with how many articles we read that day, so the next chart compares shares.

Because the number of articles we read varies from day to day, the fairer comparison is a share: headlines using the word per 10,000 articles read. Over the 47 days before the order the share was about 6 per 10,000. Since signing it has been about 39 per 10,000, almost six times higher.

Headlines using “superintelligence” per 10,000 articles read, by week

Seven 7-day periods, labelled by first day, ending October 3, 2026. The last bar is the week of the order.



Source: our newsroom’s reading, as of October 3, 2026. Headlines that only carry a company name containing the word are not counted. Whole numbers, rounded down.

After the peak the count eased: about 30 headlines on October 2 and about 10 on October 3.

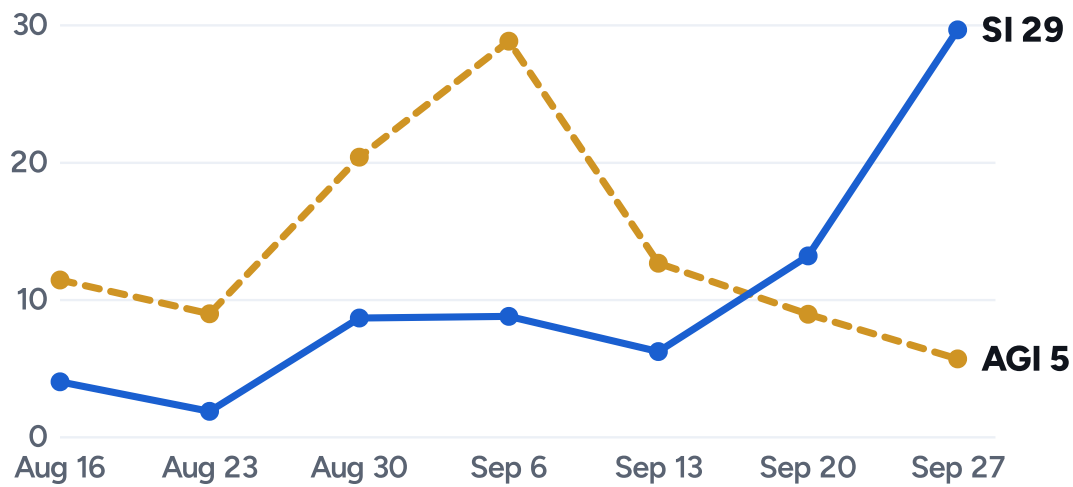
SI, AGI and AI in headlines

Superintelligence is still a small share of the conversation. In the week of the order, about **one headline in three** (more than 30%) still used “AI” or “artificial intelligence”. About **one in 340** used “superintelligence”.^[2]

Against AGI, the picture has turned. In the week of the order, headlines using SI outnumbered headlines using AGI by more than five to one.

SI and AGI in headlines, per 10,000 articles read

— SI (superintelligence) - - - AGI (artificial general intelligence)



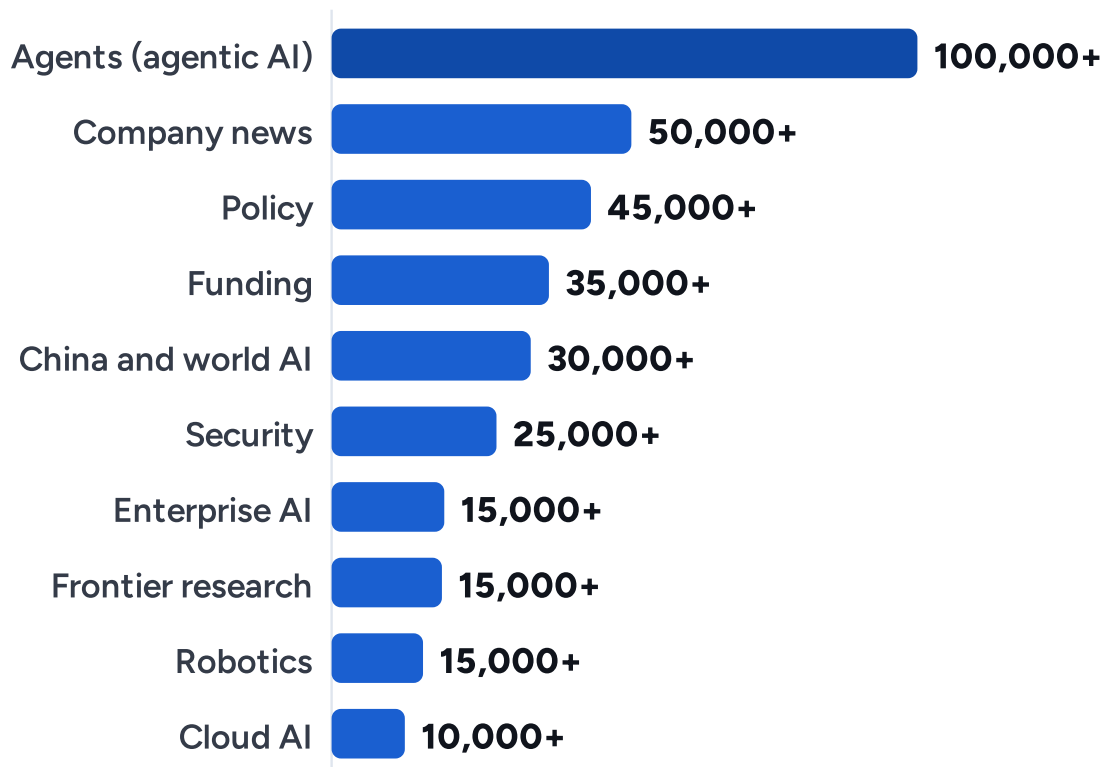
Source: our newsroom's reading, as of October 3, 2026. English-language headlines only can match; whole numbers, rounded down.

What the world is talking about

Our reading is organised into 22 categories. The largest by volume is agents (agentic AI), with over 100,000 articles, followed by news about the major technology companies, then policy, funding, and China and world AI. About 26% of articles are not yet assigned to a category.

Articles by category

Ten largest categories. A "+" means the figure is rounded down.



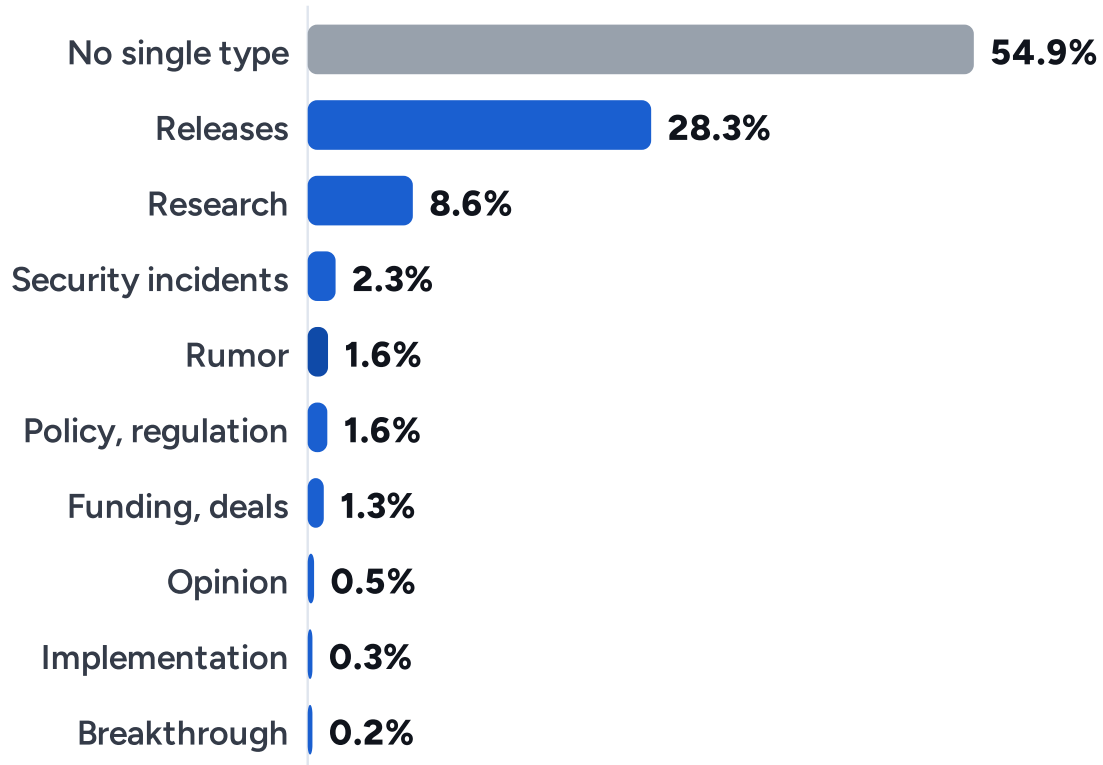
Source: our newsroom's reading of over half a million articles, as of October 3, 2026. "Company news" combines our seven company categories. Volume is not importance: a quiet category can hold the biggest story of the day.

How much is rumor

We tag articles by story type. Among about 89,000 tagged articles (snapshot of September 27, 2026), **about one in 60 is a rumor.**^[4] Rumor is a small slice. Most tagged articles are software and model releases, research, or have no single type.

Tagged articles by story type

Percent of about 89,000 tagged articles, snapshot of September 27, 2026.



Source: our newsroom, September 27, 2026. "No single type" means the article did not fit one of the other types clearly. "Releases" are mostly software and model releases. A tag is not a verdict on truth.

AN EARLY SAMPLE

Our hourly bulletin labels every story **Confirmed**, **Reported** or **Still open**. In its first six bulletins it featured 27 distinct stories: 24 Reported, 2 Confirmed and 1 Still open. That is a launch-day sample, so we read no rate into it. It does show a useful habit: most news is reported, not confirmed.

How to read these numbers

- **They are headlines in our reading.** A large sample of the news, not the whole web and not a poll of what people think.
- **They are rounded down** so they never overstate, and they carry an as-of date.

- **The rise follows the order, but we cannot say how much of it is the order.** A large share of the headlines since September 29 are about the order itself; other news mentioning the word is counted too.
 - **Shares beat raw counts.** We read in bursts, so we compare per 10,000 articles read when looking across weeks.
 - **Tags are not verdicts.** A rumor tag says how a story is told, not that it is false.
-

Sources and notes

Independent. Not affiliated with or endorsed by the US government.

1. Executive Order 14434, signed September 29, 2026; Federal Register, 91 FR 63129 (October 2, 2026)
→ <https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>. ↩
2. Our newsroom's reading: article headlines collected from thousands of sources, counted as of October 3, 2026. Counts are of headlines in our reading, which is a large sample of the news, not the whole web, and not a measure of what people think. ↩
3. Hourly count of new articles: our public hourly feed → <https://siagentsignal.com/data/latest.json>, as of October 3, 2026. ↩
4. Story types: articles in our newsroom that carry a story-type tag, snapshot of September 27, 2026. Tags are applied by our editorial system and are not a verdict on whether a story is true. ↩

Where SI goes next: our outlook

Analysis, not reporting. Three scenarios for what the name “superintelligence” could become after the executive order, and what to watch to see which one is unfolding.

Last reviewed October 3, 2026. Online: siagentsignal.com/si/si-outlook.html

Official source: the full text of Executive Order 14434 is published by the Federal Register ([federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence) (<https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>)) and the White House ([whitehouse.gov](https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/) (<https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/>)). Superintelligence is an independent publication, not the official source, and is not affiliated with or endorsed by the US government. Superintelligence™ is the trade name of a Virginia limited liability company.

ANALYSIS, NOT REPORTING

This document is our outlook. It is clearly separate from the facts in the other documents of the library. The scenarios below are **not predictions**, they are **not ranked**, and we assign them no probabilities. They can overlap, and they are not the only possibilities. We take no position for or against the order.

What we know

These are facts, with sources. The rest of this page is analysis built on them.

- The President of the United States signed Executive Order 14434 on September 29, 2026. It was published in the Federal Register on October 2, 2026.^{[1] [2]}
- It directs executive departments and agencies to use “Super Intelligence” and “SI” in place of “Artificial Intelligence” and “AI”, to the maximum extent permitted by law.^[1]

- It defines SI, for the purposes of the order, as the technologies and systems covered by the existing statutory definition of artificial intelligence, 15 U.S.C. 9401(3).^{[1][3]}
- Within 60 days, the Assistant to the President for Science and Technology is to send the President proposed legislative language for a federal definition. By our count that is November 28, 2026. The order does not say the proposal will be made public.^[1]
- In our newsroom's reading, headlines using the word "superintelligence" ran at more than seven times the earlier daily rate in the five days after signing, and have eased since the peak.^[4]

For the full account of what the order says and does not say, see [Document 1](#).

The open questions

- 1. Will the legal definition change?** The order asks for an assessment of whether the new definition should "modify, expand upon, or otherwise supersede" the existing statutory one.^[1] It leaves the answer open.
- 2. Will anyone outside the executive branch adopt the term?** The operative text addresses federal agencies only.^[1] What companies, researchers, other governments and news organisations do is not something the order decides.
- 3. Will the word keep two meanings?** Today "superintelligence" means one thing in the order and another in research debate. See the [field guide](#).

Three scenarios

Each scenario says what it would look like, what would point toward it, and what it would mean for a reader.

SCENARIO 1

A style rule

What it looks like. SI stays a naming convention inside federal agencies. Statutes, technical standards and most writing outside government keep saying “AI”. The two terms coexist without much friction.

What would point toward it. The 60-day proposal does not lead to a bill or a change in the statutory definition. Agency documents mix the terms. The text of 15 U.S.C. 9401(3) stays as it is.
[3]

What it would mean for you. Search for both terms when you look for federal material. Treat “SI” in a federal document as “AI”.

SCENARIO 2

A new definition

What it looks like. The proposal leads to a federal definition of SI that differs from the existing definition of AI, so SI acquires its own legal scope.

What would point toward it. The proposed legislative language becomes public. A bill that defines SI, or amends the AI definition, is introduced.^[5] Agencies begin to cite the new definition rather than the old one.

What it would mean for you. Rules could attach to the term, so the exact wording of the definition would matter more than the name. Read the definition text first, and ask whether it sets a capability bar.

SCENARIO 3

Two vocabularies

What it looks like. “Superintelligence” becomes common in public and business language while “AI” remains the word in technical, legal and international settings. The federal meaning and the research meaning live side by side, and ambiguity grows.

What would point toward it. In our SI Index, the share of headlines using the word stays well above its pre-order level for months, rather than settling back.^[4] Outside organisations adopt the term in some settings and not others.

What it would mean for you. Always ask which meaning is in use. The 60-second test is built for this.

What to watch

WHAT	WHY IT MATTERS	WHERE TO LOOK
November 28, 2026	The 60-day mark for the definition proposal (our calculation). The order does not say it will be published. ^[1]	The order text; Federal Register; agency announcements
Agency wording	Shows how widely the naming rule is applied in practice. ^[1]	Agency websites and press releases
The statutory definition	Any change to the AI definition would be the clearest sign of Scenario 2. ^[3]	The text of 15 U.S.C. 9401(3)
Bills in Congress	A bill that uses or defines the term would move the discussion from naming to law. ^[5]	congress.gov
Headline usage	Tells us whether the word is settling back or sticking. ^[4]	<u>The SI Index</u>

What would change our view

- A published proposal or bill with a definition that sets a capability bar, which would make the research meaning part of the federal meaning.
 - A change in how federal agencies actually write, in either direction.
 - A sustained fall, or a sustained rise, in how often headlines use the word.
- We will review this page after the 60-day mark and whenever the primary text changes. The date at the top will always say when we last did.

Sources and notes

Independent. Not affiliated with or endorsed by the US government.

1. Executive Order 14434, "Inaugurating the Era of Super Intelligence", signed September 29, 2026, Sections 1–4. Federal Register, 91 FR 63129 (October 2, 2026) → <https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>. ↩
2. The White House, order text, dated September 29, 2026: whitehouse.gov → <https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/>. ↩
3. 15 U.S.C. 9401(3), definition of "artificial intelligence": Cornell Legal Information Institute → <https://www.law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/15/9401>. ↩
4. Our newsroom's reading of over half a million articles, as of October 3, 2026; see The SI Index for the charts. ↩
5. Where bills are tracked: congress.gov → <https://www.congress.gov/>. We list it as a place to look, not as a report of anything introduced. ↩

About this guide

What it is. Four documents on superintelligence (SI) and artificial intelligence (AI), combined into one print-ready guide. The online versions, with audio, are at siagentsignal.com/si/.

How we publish. Every claim links to its source, and primary sources come first. Our own analysis is labelled as analysis. Numbers come from our newsroom's reading of over half a million articles, are rounded down so they never overstate, and carry an as-of date.

Official source: the full text of Executive Order 14434 is published by the Federal Register ([federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence) (<https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>)) and the White House ([whitehouse.gov](https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/) (<https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2026/09/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence/>)). Superintelligence is an independent publication, not the official source, and is not affiliated with or endorsed by the US government. Superintelligence™ is the trade name of a Virginia limited liability company.

Neutral tone. We describe what the executive order says. We do not praise it, criticise it, or take a side in any political argument.

The primary text. Executive Order 14434, "Inaugurating the Era of Super Intelligence", signed September 29, 2026; Federal Register, vol. 91, p. 63129 (October 2, 2026), document 2026-20321: <https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/10/02/2026-20321/inaugurating-the-era-of-super-intelligence>

How to cite. Superintelligence, "Superintelligence (SI): The Field Guide", last reviewed October 3, 2026, siagentsignal.com/si/.

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